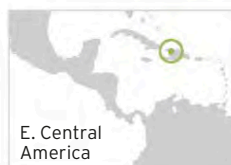


Citadelle Laferrière

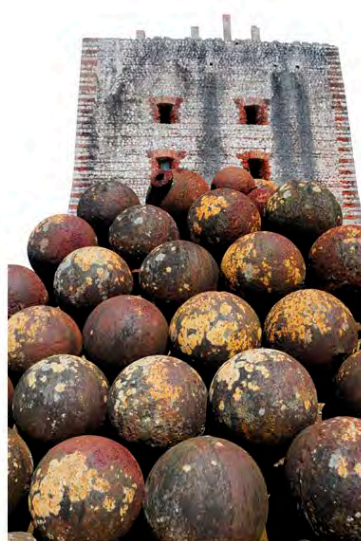
An anticolonial fortress, now the symbol of the independent nation of Haiti



In 1791, African slaves on the West Indian island of Haiti rose in revolt against their French colonial masters. The French sent a substantial force of soldiers in 1802 to retake the island, but most died of fever. On January 1, 1804, Jean-Jacques Dessalines, leader of the revolution, proclaimed Haiti independent.

Built to impress

Fearing a renewed attack by the French, General Henri Christophe (1767–1820), in charge of northern Haiti, ordered the construction of a huge fortress. Work began in 1805 and continued until 1820. The foundation stones were laid directly into the mountain stone, held in place by a mortar of quicklime, molasses, local cows' and goats' blood, and cows' hooves cooked to a glue. Cisterns and storehouses were also built to supply enough water and food for 5,000 defenders for 1 year.



▽ STRATEGICALLY LOCATED

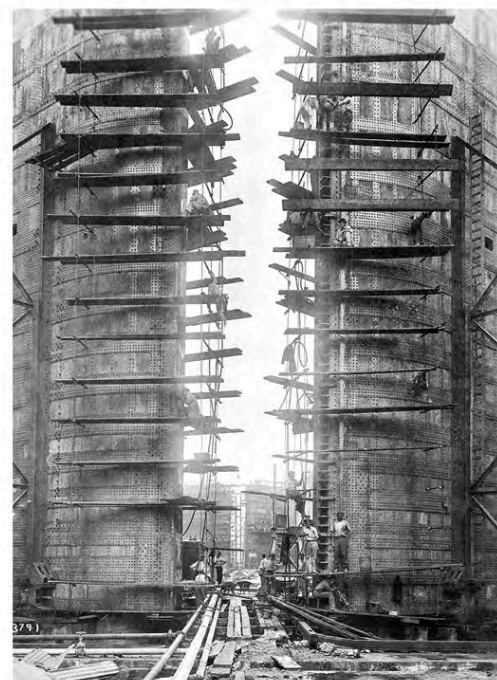
Citadelle Laferrière stands on top of a 3,000-ft- (900-m-) high mountain and covers more than 110,000 square ft (10,000 square m). The fortress's angular walls are 13 ft (4 m) thick and tower 130 ft (40 m) above the ground.

△ STILL STACKED

The Haitians amassed an arsenal that included about 160 cannons to defend the fortress. Piles of cannonballs still lie in stacks at the base of its walls.



About **20,000 workers** toiled for **15 years** to build this massive fortress



△ LARGEST LOCKS

At 110 ft (33.5 m) wide and 1,050 ft (320 m) long, the Gatún Locks at the northern Caribbean end of the canal are the largest in the canal. The locks lift ships up 87 ft (27 m) above sea level into the Gatún Lake.